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Conference 2014

Innovative Museum Exhibits: telling a story by means of an engaging experience

Roberto Frasca, Davide Pantile,
Matteo Ventrella, Giovanni Verreschi

ETT s.p.a. - Italy



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The context

- **Thirty years of Change, Inside and Outside Museums**:
  - Museum objects are no longer the central element: **the communication** aspect is becoming prevalent
  - New technologies and "**virtual dimension**" create spaces and experiences that **go beyond architectural spaces and museum collection limits.**
- → shift from the idea of a **collection-oriented** museum to a **visitor-oriented** one



Our approach

- Starting points:
  - ***Boredom is the most fearsome enemy for a Museum***
  - ***A museum, to attract, must surprise every visitor***

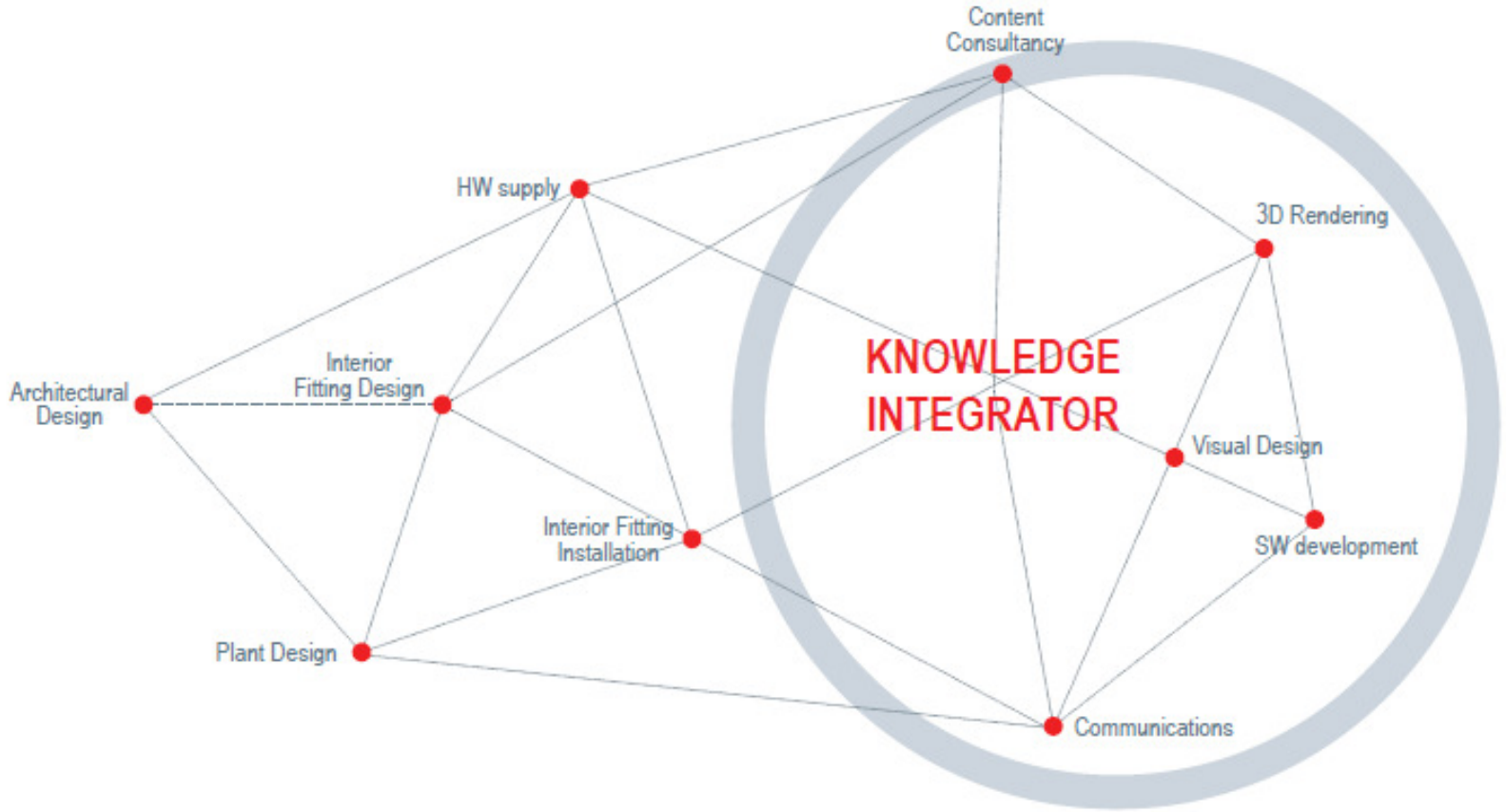
→ Our guidelines:

- Use innovative technologies **to enhance visitor engagement** and interaction
- Give visitors an **active role to play**, part **visit**or – part **act**or: a "**visit-actor"**
- Define the goal of an **"immersive museum"**, in which the visit-actor is **absorbed into the storyline**

Our guidelines

- **HOW DO WE DO THIS?**
  - **Interactivity and multisensory involvement**, information sharing, personalisation of content
  - By **catering to different levels of understanding**, so that both children and adults have a positive reaction to the visit
  - Having **new content available** for visitor-actors, each time they return
  - Assuring **progressive technological and content upgrading**
  - Using applications to put over the **exhibition message**, and not just to show off the technology
  - Amplification of visit-actor perception using **augmented** and **virtual realities**

OUR PHILOSOPHY



“Excavate and learn”

- **Visitors put on an archaeologist’s shoes**:
  - Archaeological excavations reproduction
  - Finds with RFID/NFC tags
  - Multimedia content and information

- **Technologies:**
  - RFID/NFC object recognition
  - Touch and multi-touch screens
  - Interactive videos
  - 3D reconstructions



The 202th Chiappa Battery Visitor Centre - Portofino

- Restored military building: **a time trip back to World War II**
- **Visitor Centre**
  - Multi-selection rear-projection with 4 scenes / clips
  - A touchscreen with a picture and photo archive, video interviews and documents, 3D reconstructions
  - Immersive environmental audio tracks
- **Trails**
  - 16 panels with QR Codes, located on the new path to the bunkers
- **Mobile Apps**
  - History of the batteries on Portofino promontory
  - Description of the installations (POI) to be found in the batteries



Augmented reality: Liguria Heritage

- **Augmented Reality** mobile app (Liguria Heritage AR)
  - Geo-localized historical and archaeological sites in Liguria region
  - Historical characters, shown as 3D avatar guides, tell each site's history
  - Multimedia content and information

- **Technologies:**
  - iOS and Android platform
  - Augmented reality
  - 3D Avatar
  - GPS tracking



“4D Storm Chamber”

- **A multi-sensorial experience:** visit-actor finds himself in the shoes of a shipwrecked survivor on board an open lifeboat
  - Moving boat
  - Stormy seas animation
  - Water spray and wind

- **Technologies:**
  - Video animation of 3D reconstructions
  - Multi-sensorial effects: wind, water, nebulisation, fog, 3 axis movement
  - Video-processing



Conclusions: what have we learnt ?

- Innovative technologies play an active role to cater, simultaneously, to different levels of understanding and to stimulate **interest** and **participation** from a **transversal target**
- The new approach to museum exhibition design allow children, adults, casual visitors and experts to have a **positive reaction** to the visit.
- Visit-actors need/expect new content to be on offer each time they come back. Progressive technological and content upgrading needs to be part of the philosophy.
- Applications must be used according with the **storytelling** to get the exhibition message across effectively:
- → it is important to consider that the **technology is the means, the message is the "goal"**



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